RUTGERS

Midterm Review

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Please pick up your **name card** from the front

Assignment 3, Part 3

The spy saw the agent with the binoculars on the roof.

- draw syntax trees for the original sentence, NOT the interpretations
- so the main idea here is to capture different **modification** relation on **the same sentence**, which reflects **structural difference** on the tree

Syntax Rules Across Languages

speakers of different languages will have different syntax rules

- because they have different mental grammars

consider these phrases from **different languages**:

- for each phrase, I've given a simplified version of a phrase structure rule for English
- how would you modify that rule to account for each phrase?
- what would you have to change?
- assume that these languages place each adjective in an AdjP and each noun in an NP, as English does

English Rule: **NP → D AdjP N**

Portuguese

a	casa	amarela
the	house	yellow

'*the yellow house*'

English Rule: **PP → P NP**

Japanese

gakkō	de
school	at

'*at school*'

English Rule: **VP → V NP**

Quechua

t'antata	mikhurqani
bread	I.ate

'*I ate bread*.'

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Japanese

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English Rule: **VP → NP V**

Quechua

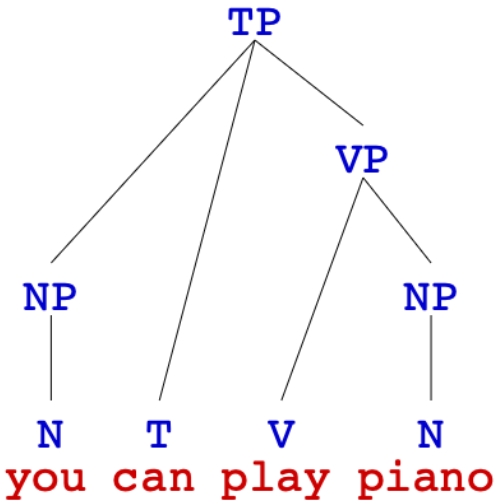
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'*I ate bread*.'

Syntactic Transformations

- once we understand how to draw a syntax tree for a simple sentence, we can use it as a basis for more complex ideas, such as **syntactic transformations**

- for example, we can say the following sentence because it follows English rules: TP → NP T VP

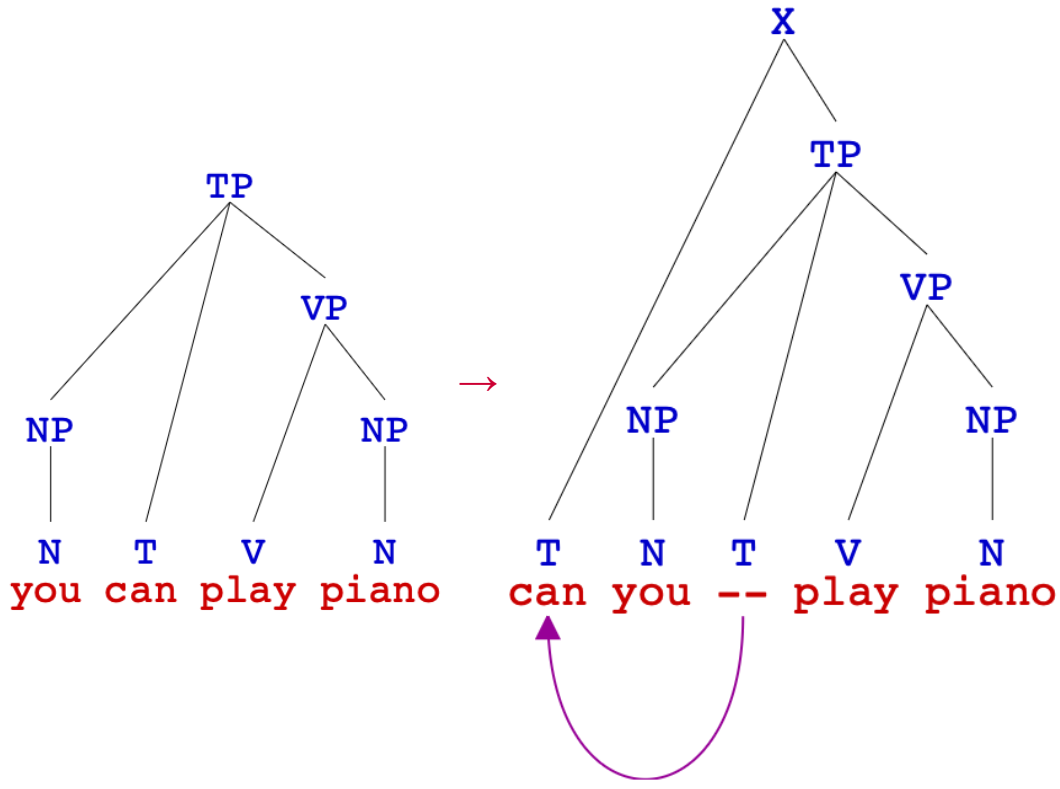


'*You can play piano.*'.

- but what if we made it a question: ***Can you play piano?***

Syntactic Transformations

- to make questions, we need to apply **transformations**: move constituents about in the tree
- move *can* **up into** another level above TP: now we have a **yes-no question**!

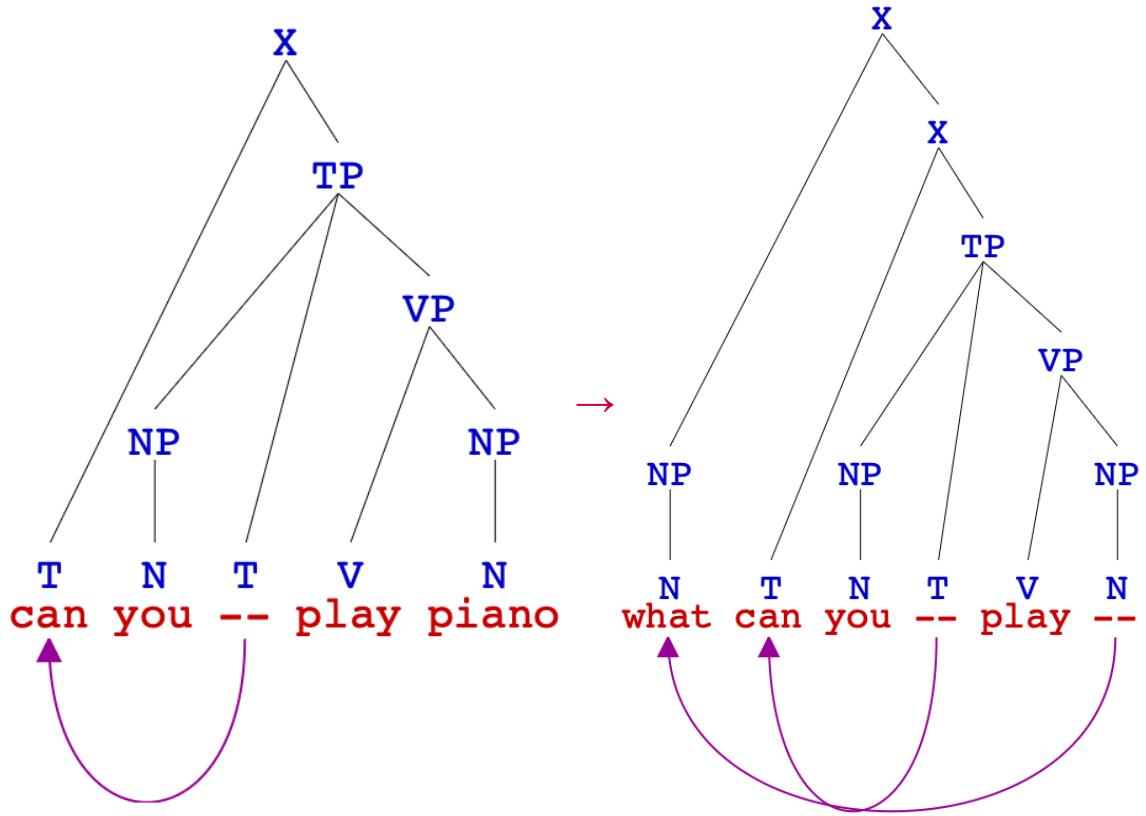


Syntactic Transformations

what if we wanted to make a wh- question

- ***What can you play?***

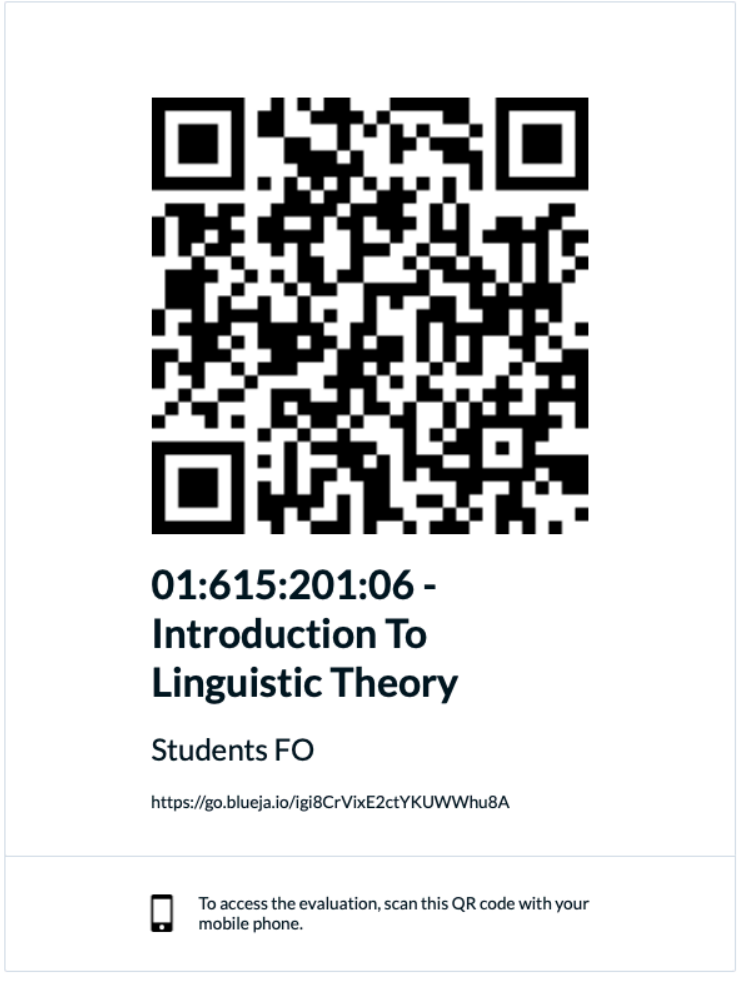
- what does *what* represent?
- **replace** piano with *what* and **move** it one level above *can*



Mid-course Survey

mid-course survey link

please take a few minutes to complete the survey



How well do you know each of these topics?

basic concepts in Linguistics

- mental grammar/linguistic competence
- descriptivism vs. prescriptivism
- Grammatical vs. ungrammatical language
- standard vs. non-standard language

Syntax

- parts of speech: definitions of nouns, verbs, etc.
- parts of speech: morphological and syntactic distribution of nouns, verbs, etc.
- constituents
- phrase structure rules (PSRs)
- types of phrases: NP, AdjP, AdvP, PP, VP, TP
- complex sentences: main and dependent clauses, complementisers, CP
- sentences and tree structure

Morphology

- morphemes
- roots vs. affixes
- roots vs. stems
- types of affixes
- free vs. bound morphemes
- derivational vs. inflectional morphemes
- allomorphs
- monomorphemic and polymorphemic words
- simple and compound words
- morphological processes
  - affixation
  - compounding
  - reduplication
  - alternation
  - suppletion
  - zero-derivation
- order of affixation

How well can you apply these analytical tools in practice?

- break down words **into morphemes** and identify the **type** of each morpheme
- identify specific **morphological processes**
- analyze the morphological structure of an **unfamiliar language**
- draw a **morphological tree** to illustrate a word's structure and **order of affixation**
- identify a word's **part of speech**
- use morphological and syntactic **distribution** to determine a word's part of speech
- use **constituency tests** to determine if a sequence of words is a constituent
- identify different **types of phrase**: NP, PP, AdjP, AdvP, VP, TP
- identify the **head** of a phrase
- use **phrase structure rules** to combine words into phrases
- draw **syntax trees** to illustrate a sentence's internal structure

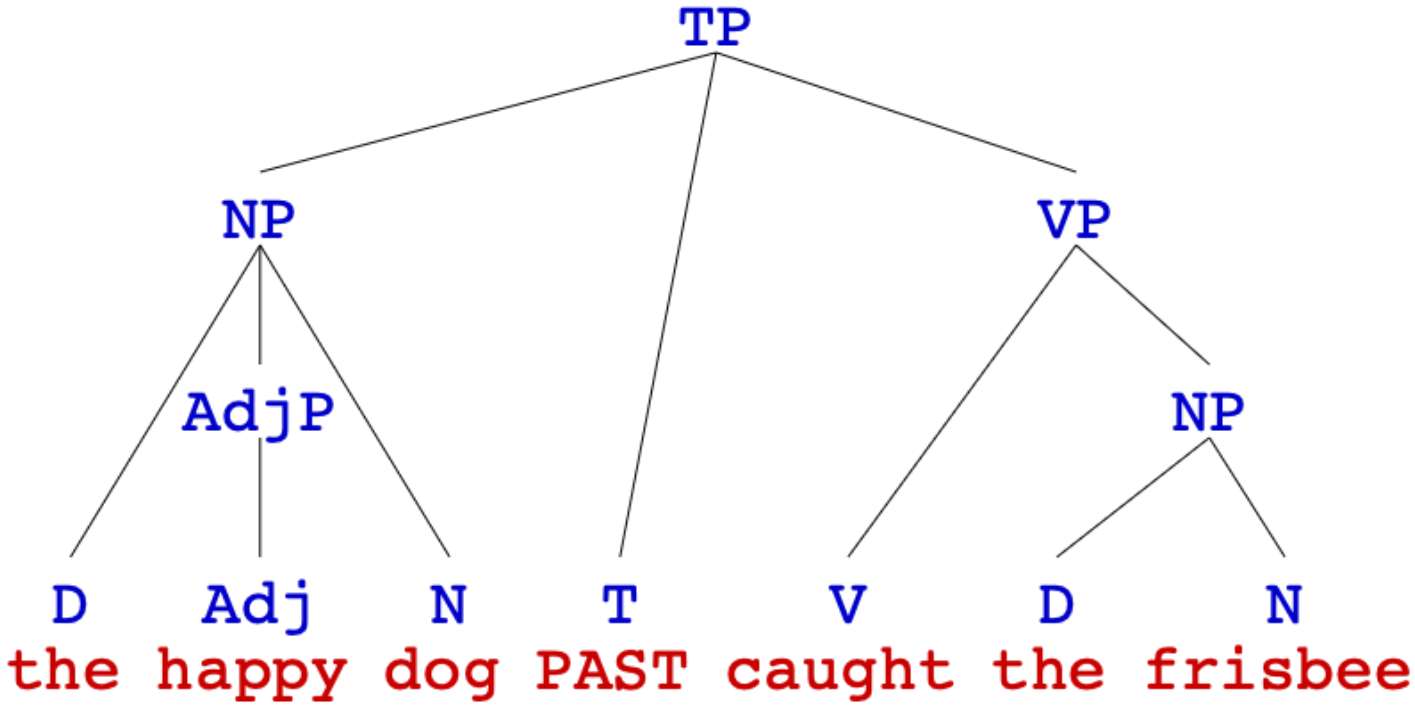
Syntax Tree Practice

Draw syntax trees for the following sentence.

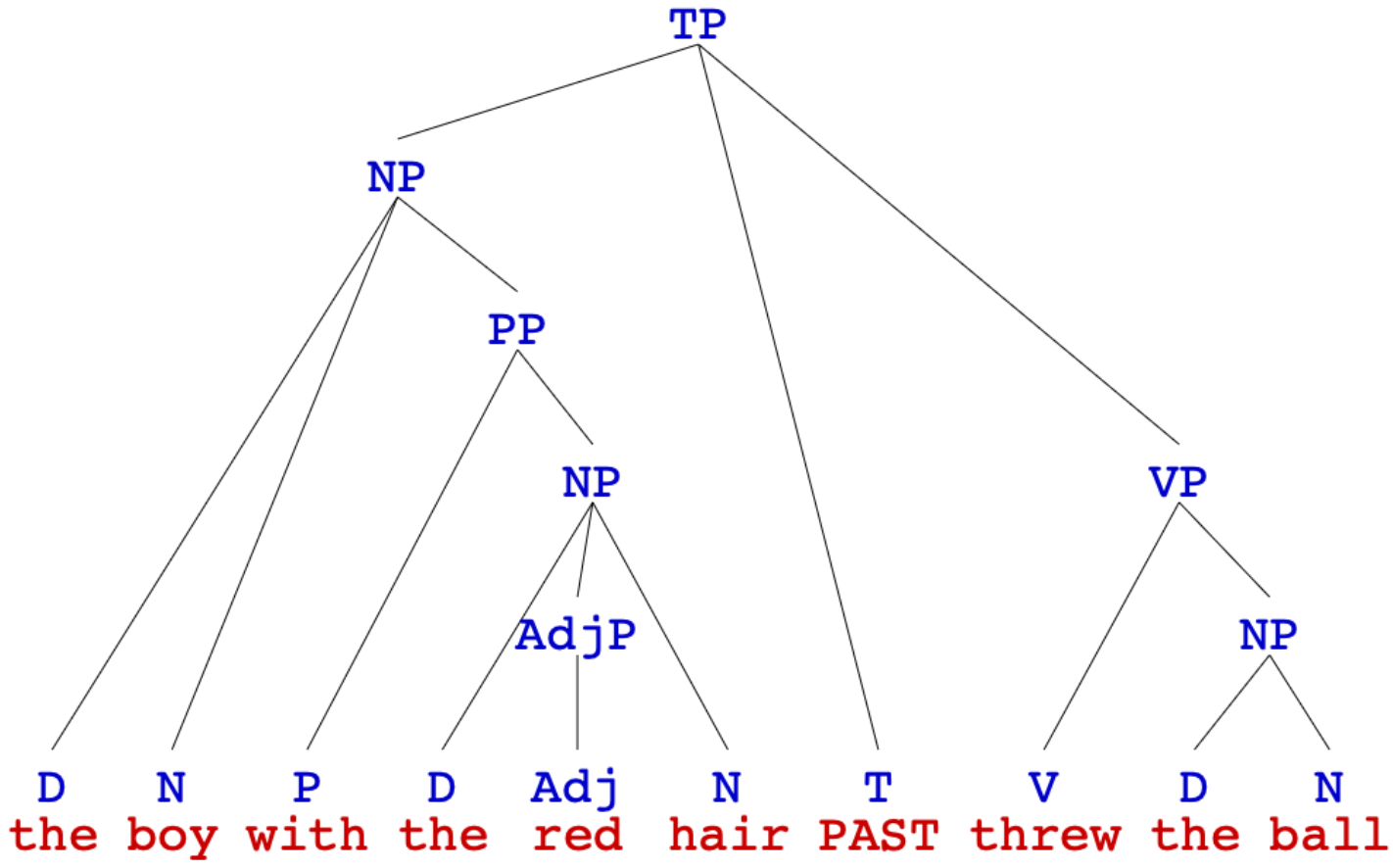
1. The happy dog caught the frisbee.
2. The boy with the red hair threw the ball.
3. Harriet ate a bagel for breakfast.
4. Frank happily ate a plate of nachos.
5. The old man rowed his boat gently down the stream.
6. I bought a beautiful bouquet of flowers for my mom.



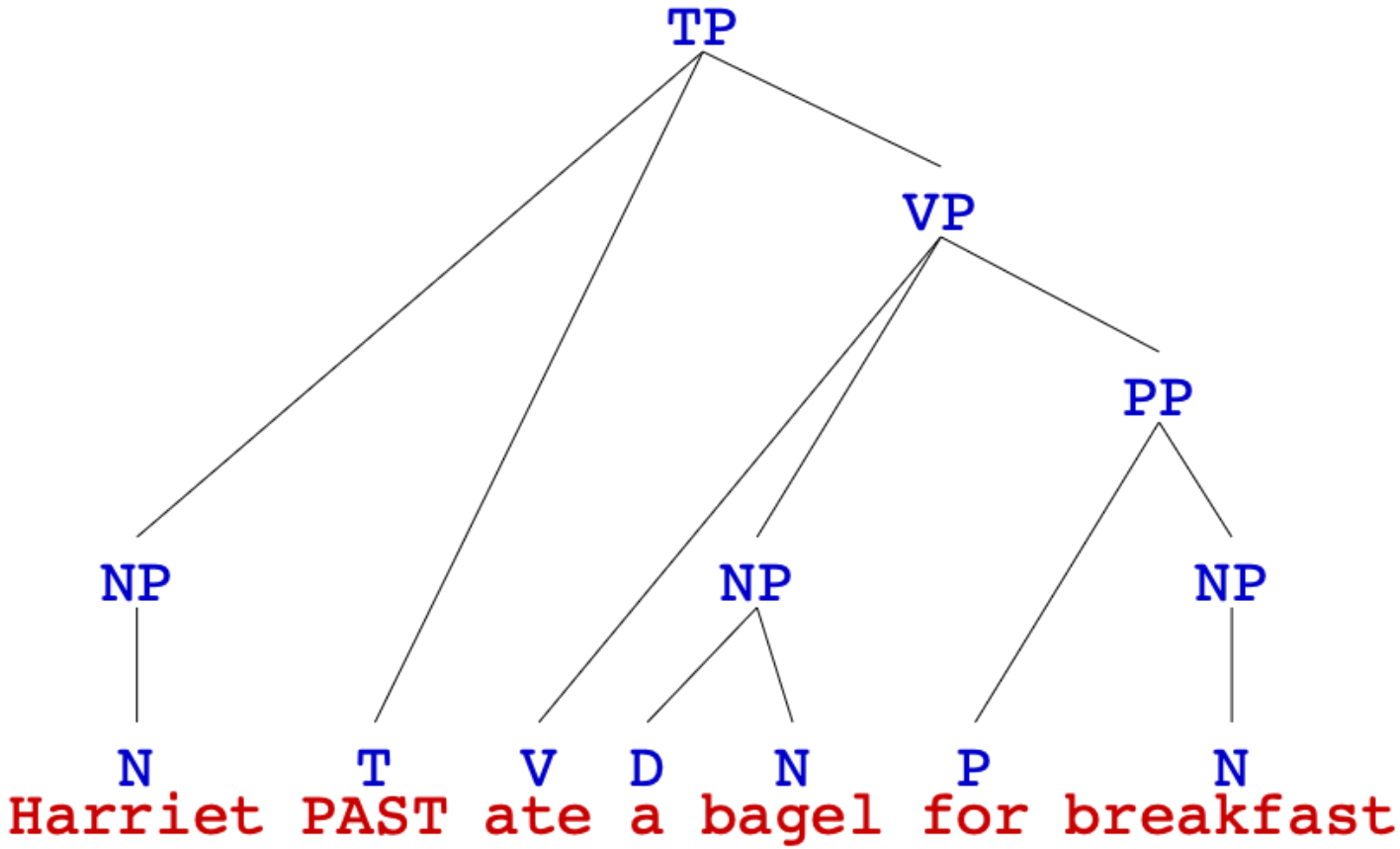
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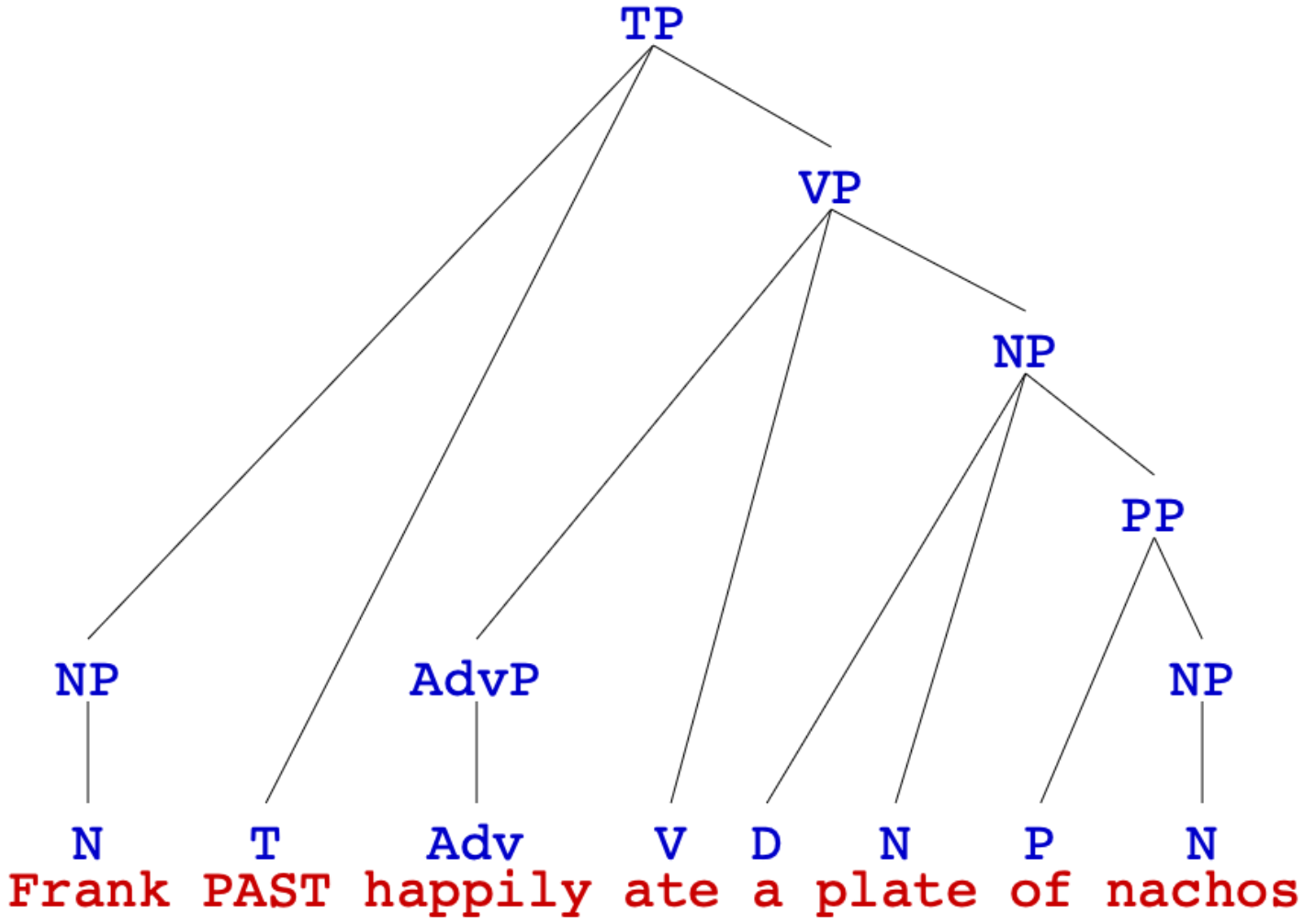
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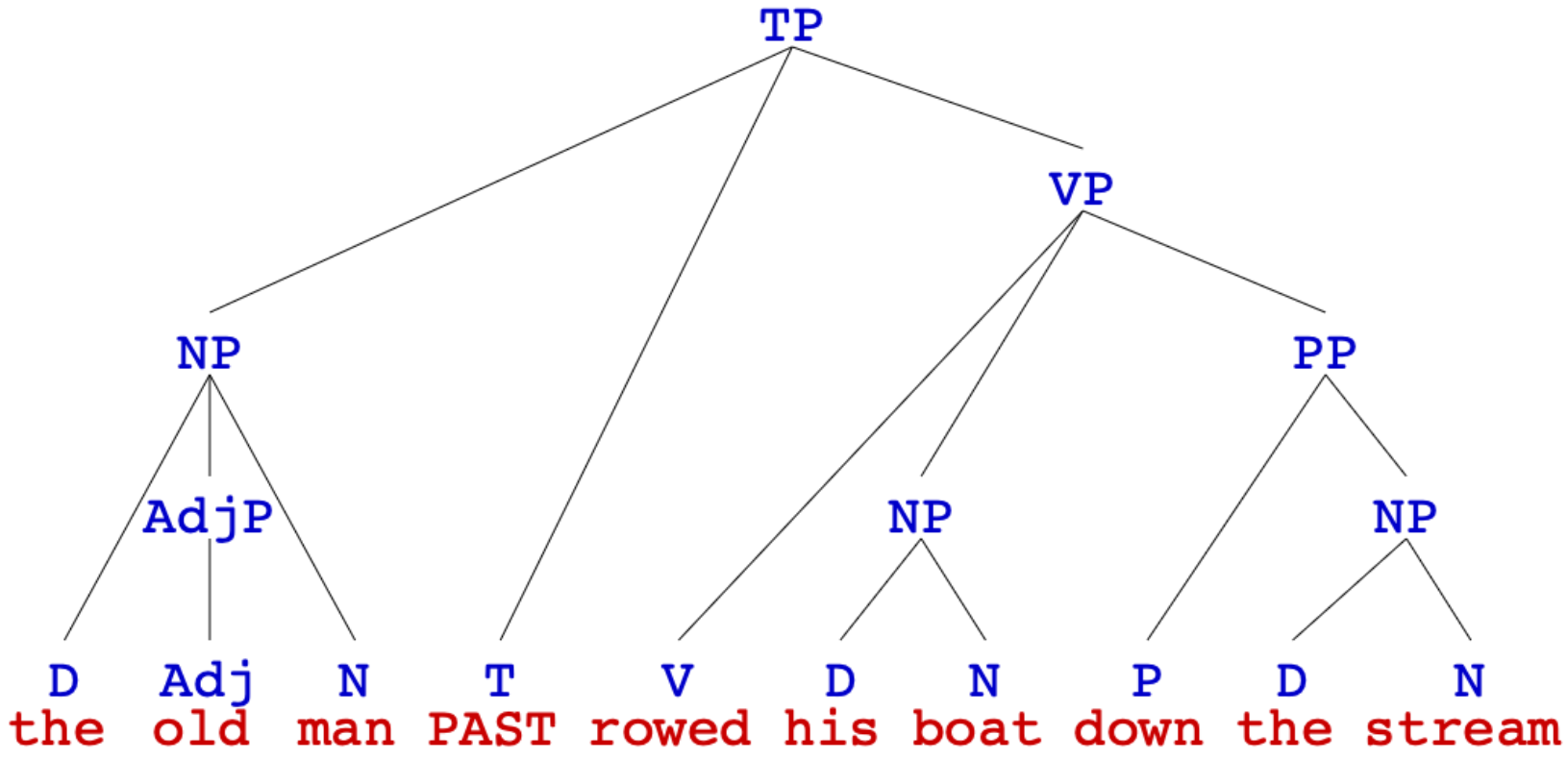
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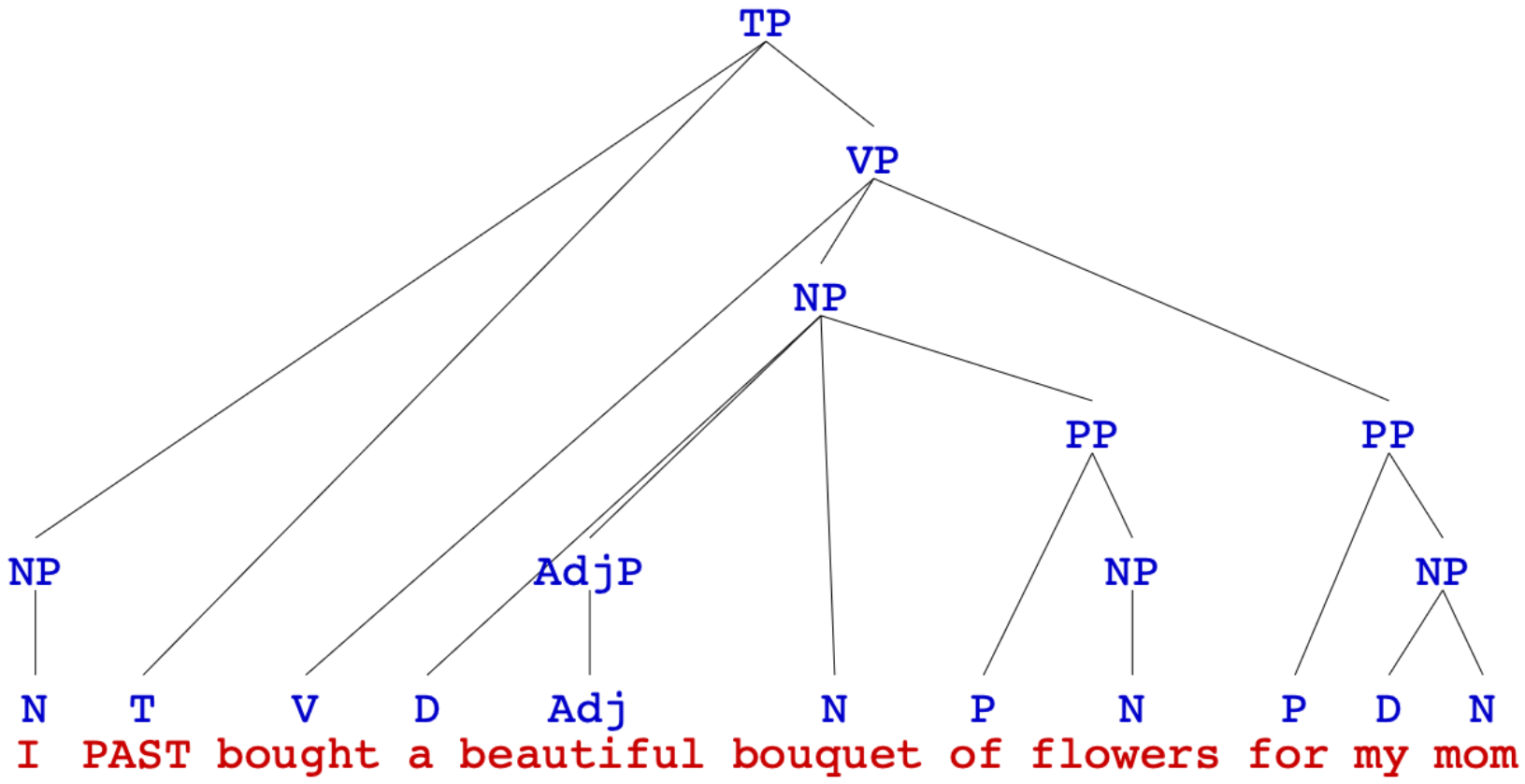
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6. I bought a beautiful bouquet of flowers for my mom.



good luck with the **MIDTERM** (**Oct 14** at class time)

SEMANTICS coming up

reading: the chapter **Semantics I: Compositionality** from Victoria Fromkin et al.'s *An Introduction to Language*



Slides created via the R package **xaringan**.